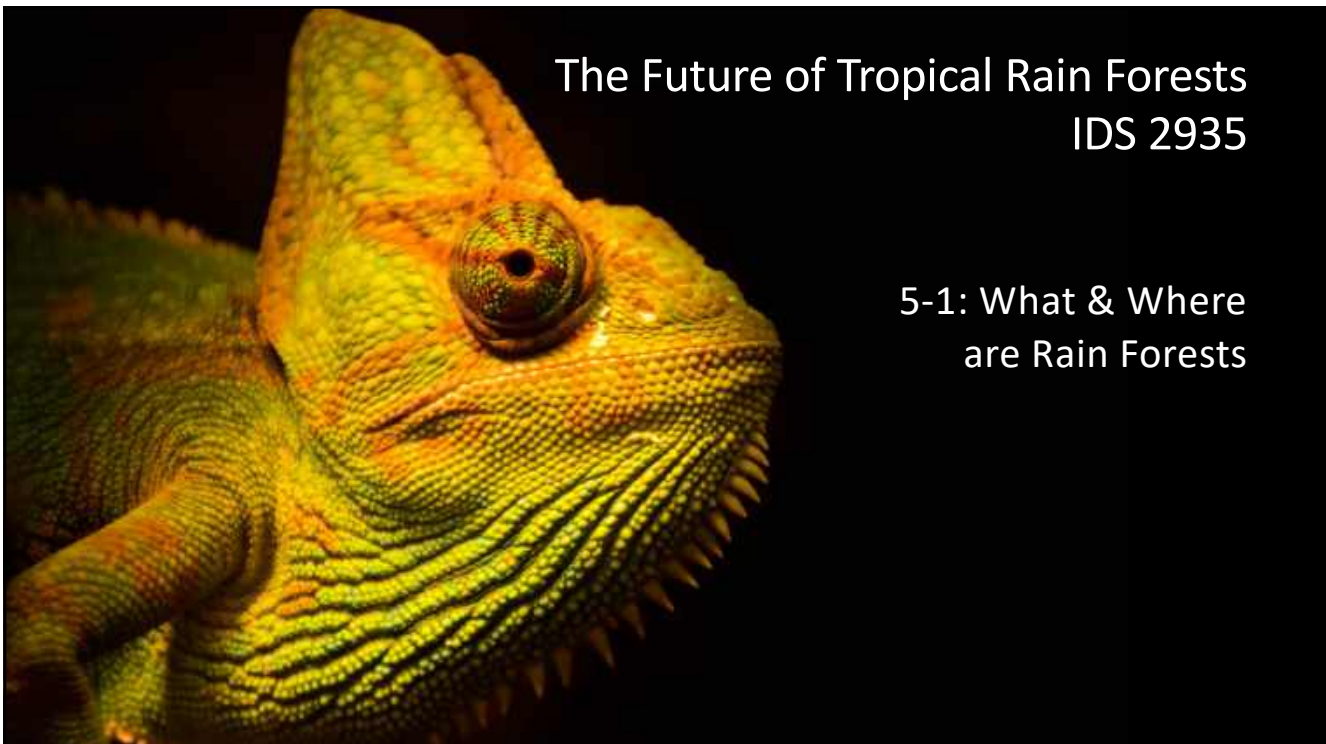




The Future of Tropical Rain Forests IDS 2935

5-1: What & Where are Rain Forests

1



What are Rain Forests

Where are Rain Forests

Yangambi Engagement Landscape, DRC.
Photo by Axel Fassio/CIFOR

2

What

trees

Evergreen (mostly)

Grow straight & tall

Little branching until
reaching the canopy

Phenology observation by
INERA technicians in
Yangambi, DRC.
Photo by Axel Fassio/CIFOR



3

What

trees



Buttress Roots



Stilt Roots

Photo by [Rob and Stephanie Levy](#) (CC BY 2.0)

Photo by [Vilseknogen](#) (CC BY-NC 2.0)

4

What

trees

The biggest
ones are...
very big



5



Giant Kapok (*Ceiba pentandra*)
Barro Colorado Island, Panama
Photo: Jorge Aleman, STRI

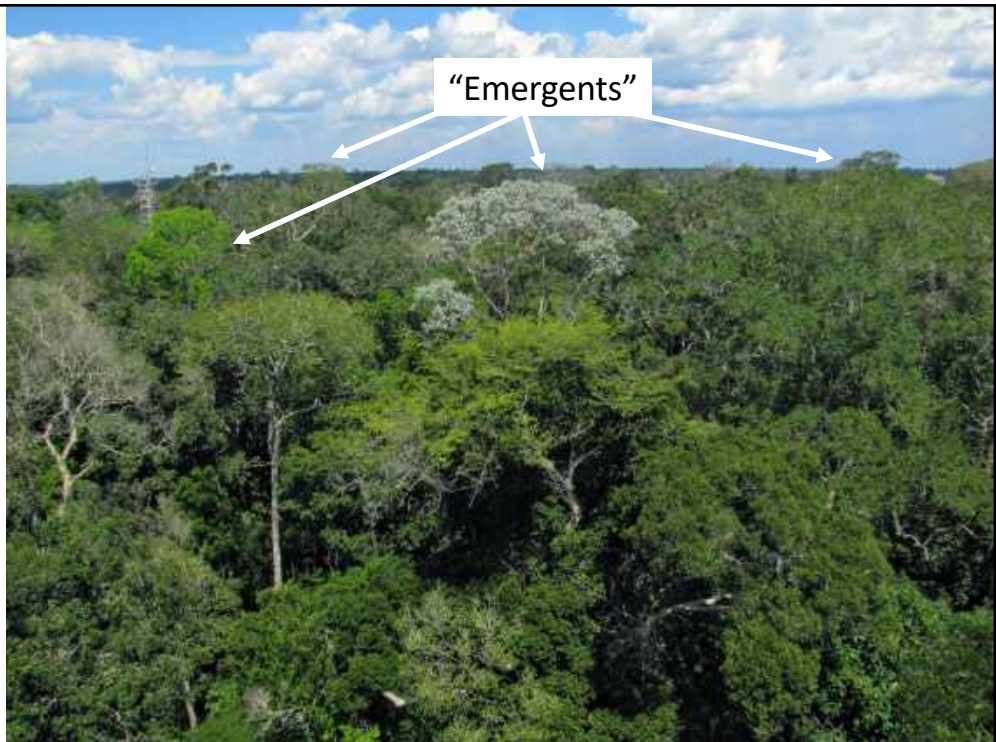
6

What

Layers (aka "strata")

1. Canopy

Central Amazonia, Brazil
Photo by E. Bruna



7

What

layers

2. Subcanopy (aka midcanopy)

Central Amazonia, Brazil
Photo by E. Bruna



8

What

layers

- 3. Understory
- 4. Forest Floor

Central Amazonia, Brazil
Photo by E. Bruna



9

What

variety

- Trees
- Treelets
- Shrubs
- Lianas
(woody vines)
- Herbs
- Palms

Danum Valley,
Borneo, Malaysia
by [Jeremy Bezanger](#)



Atherton
Tablelands,
Australia



Atherton Tablelands, Australia

10

What
variety

Herbs	Bamboo
Palms	Herbs
Epiphytes	(orchids, bromeliads)



[Brewbooks](#): *Heliconia rostrata* (CC BY-SA 2.0)



Sinnochia
Cymbidium lancifolium
(CC BY 2.0)

[Dick Culbert](#): *Bactris gasipaes* (CC BY 2.0)



11

What

dark

Central Amazonia, Brazil
Time: 3:06 pm



12

What

dark

Central Amazonia, Brazil
Time: 4:02 pm



13



14

Sunflecks



15

There are actually many different
types of **Tropical Rain Forest**

16



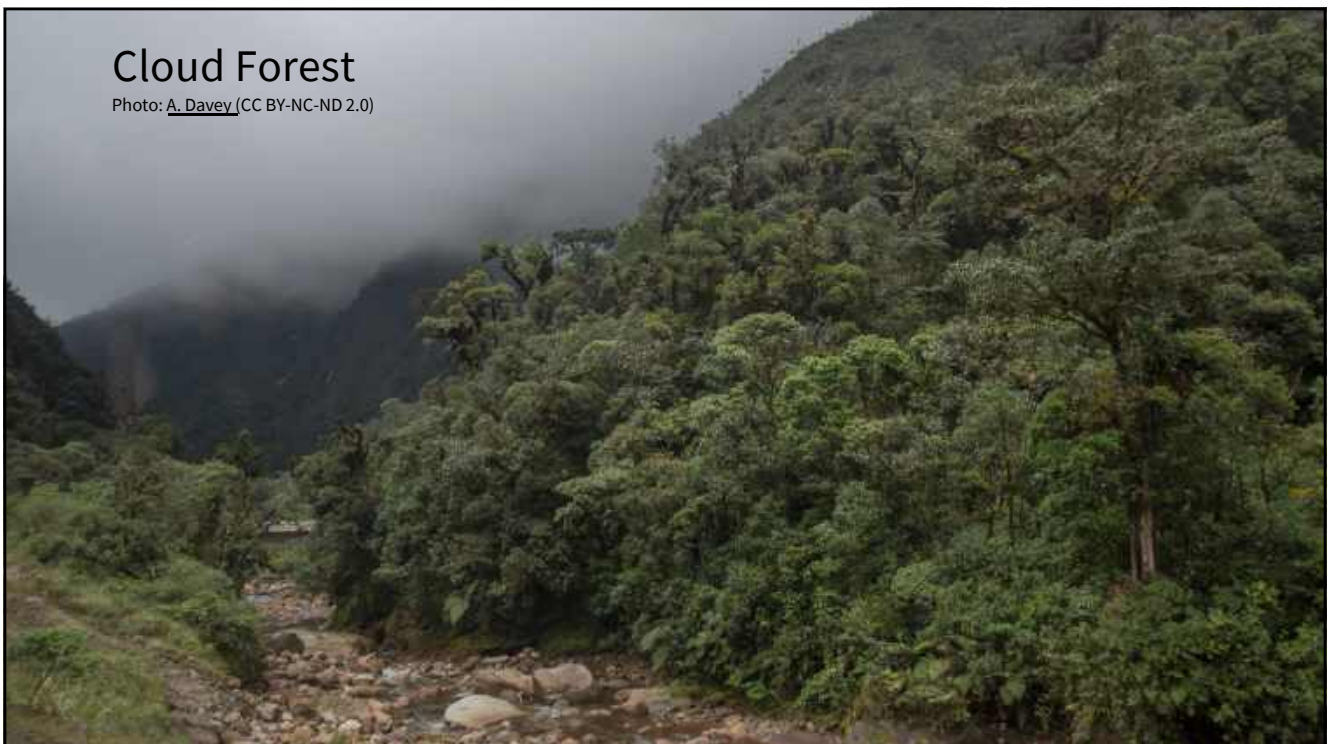
17



18



19



20



21

What's Missing?

22

Rain

Heat

Biodiversity

23



24



25